

Production

Country	Million tonnes
 China	14.53
 India	5.97
 Kenya	2.33
 Sri Lanka	1.40
 Turkey	1.30
 Vietnam	1.12
 Indonesia	0.60
 Bangladesh	0.44
 Argentina	0.36
 Uganda	0.33
World	29.76

Source: (FAO)^[85]

Tea is mainly grown in Asia and Africa, with smaller areas in South America and around the Black and Caspian Seas. The four biggest tea-producing countries are China, India, Kenya and Sri Lanka, together representing 81% of world tea production. Smaller hubs of production include such places as [São Miguel Island, Azores](#), in Portugal, and [Guria](#), in Georgia. In 2022, global production of tea was 29.8 million [tonnes](#), led by China with 49% and India with 20% of the world total. [Kenya](#), [Sri Lanka](#), and [Turkey](#) were secondary producers.^[86]

Storage

Storage conditions determine the [shelf life](#) of tea; black tea shelf life is greater than that of green teas. Some, such as flower teas, may last only a month or so. Others, such as pu-erh, improve with age. To remain fresh and prevent mold, tea needs to be stored away from heat, light, air, and moisture. Tea must be kept at room temperature in an air-tight container. Black tea in a bag within a sealed opaque canister may keep for two years. Green tea deteriorates more rapidly, usually in less than a year. Tightly rolled [gunpowder tea](#) leaves keep longer than the more open-leafed [Chun Mee tea](#).

Storage life for all teas can be extended by using [desiccant](#) or oxygen-absorbing packets, vacuum sealing, or refrigeration in air-tight containers (except green tea, where discrete use of refrigeration or freezing is recommended and temperature variation kept to a minimum).^[87]